options against Pakistan, preventing New Delhi from taking action that, however costly, might convince the Pakistanis to revisit their tolerance for anti-Indian militancy.

Finally, nuclear weapons pose a danger in the context of Pakistan's unstable domestic political and security environment. Pakistan's nuclear arsenal is under tight control of the army, the most powerful institution in the country. The army has enormous incentives to ensure the weapons' security, and there is no evidence to suggest that they face any immediate threat. Still, in an extreme situation, the Pakistani arsenal might be vulnerable. For example, if Pakistan attempts to move weapons during a crisis with India, militants might be able to seize them as they are being transported—particularly if the jihadis have the assistance of insiders with access to the weapons' transport schedule. Of course, even if they managed to steal a weapon, the militants would still have to maintain possession of it and determine how to use it. These would be difficult tasks. Nonetheless, Pakistani nuclear security is a genuine concern. Nuclear weapons thus are unhelpful in addressing the challenge of Islamist militancy in South Asia; they might even potentially pose dangers of their own.[37]

What, then, is the solution to South Asia's sorcerer's apprentice problem? The situation will require a radical rethinking of the region's security framework. Both India and Pakistan must adopt policies that transcend their traditional comfort zones. The Pakistani government must truly forswear militancy, ending support for the jihadis and accepting international military and financial assistance in crushing them. The Pakistanis need to recognize that the costs of supporting militancy outweigh its benefits and that Mumbai may present it with a final opportunity to get control of the situation. If the government does not act against the militants soon, it may lose control of the state or find itself drawn into a catastrophic conflict with India in the wake of another terrorist attack.

Islamabad's initial response to allegations of a Pakistani link to the Mumbai attacks was one of denial and defiance. However, given mounting evidence of a Pakistani connection to the attacks, as well as American, British, and UN pressure, Pakistan changed its position, arresting militant leaders and shutting down Jamaat-ud-